

Case Study: Define and own the end-to-end experience and remove ambiguity - for a new streaming product launch

Title

Own and define the end-to-end experience and remove ambiguity - for a new streaming product launch

Description

Lead the end-to-end experience, working with third party partners, product, design, development, and research to launch a new streaming service combo.

Role

Lead experience architect

Scope

Partnered with third-party partners (Netflix, HBO-Max), product value, research, design, marketing and other teams to create an end-to-end digital experience.

Impact

Introduced a combined streaming product, at an exclusive price, that customers loved.

Context

Launching a new streaming service with two partners that fits into the current service model for Verizon, satisfies our partners, and is clear to customers.

A streaming service with two different vendors is a first for Verizon. Also, not something our current service model handles exactly. And we know we'll need to be crystal clear

for customers on how to sign up using their existing service, and how to upgrade their subscription, if they want no ads.

Artifacts

Wireframes and visuals from the work.

Approach

How the work came together.

Worked with the partner and product team to discuss how the new service (in Verizon parlance a “perk”) would work, constraints, etc. My focus was to understand Netflix's concerns and needs from an experience standpoint, clarify ambiguity, and identify possible areas of friction with Netflix and in the experience.

Key Decisions

Where the design point of view mattered most.

Understanding partner approach/constraints and impacts on the perk

Based on meeting with Netflix (and HBO-Max), and asking questions about their subscription and new/existing customer sign up flows, I understood that we would not be able to customize or greatly influence their existing experiences. Additionally, I realized I needed to do detailed screen shots and flows for different paths for our partners and consider how to address those friction points elsewhere.

Netflix was in particular concerned with customers registering for the service and had high expectations for that. We had experiences in place to handle that as we had encountered this problem before (although this spurred a consideration in experience that would be adopted later on).

Understanding our current perk and friction points

I looked at the high level experience for this perk and mapped it across the main digital experience touchpoints - Buy, Manage, Pay, Use. Two of the key friction points we identified were:

1. Customers would need to manage and sign up for two different services from one perk. Our experience did not support that. The combined service had to seem like a single thing, but clearly show/allow customers to manage registration/subscription individually.
2. Customers needed to understand that it would be easy to sign up as existing customers of Netflix or Max/HBO, and that they could change from ads version to another version. Our research identified that the overlap of Verizon and Netflix customer was 80-90%. So this was a key pain point to solve for.

For #1, we showed Netflix/Max as “one thing” in Buy and Pay - but with separately manageable services for manage and use functions.

For #2, we knew we could NOT allow the customer to directly choose a different level of subscription from the Netflix/Max perk. So in the Perk description and FAQs we needed to clearly identify that this would be possible, how to do it, and that it would be easy - identifying any potential issues.

Outcomes

What changed as a result.

- The result was a successful launch. It is our second-best selling perk, on nearly 11 million mobile accounts today.
- We created a new experience framework to combine two services in a perk - which we could utilize for future perks.
- We worked out a framework for upgrading existing subscriptions and how that would show up in the experience.
- The germ of the idea for managing unused subscriptions was planted. We would later adopt a rule of removing subscriptions that were unregistered after 90 days.